

Living by Faith: Hebrews 11 Hall of Fame

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Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-17

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories
Book 60 of 60

*iyu — Haqenya neger, midri kitri'yu intezeyke'alkum iwin ab tiHti igrikum zelo ts'inu'e
neger.*

Scene 2 of 25

[PICTURE: Abel kneeling before a simple stone altar with the firstborn of his flock, flames rising heavenward as God accepts his offering. His face shows reverent joy. In the background, Cain watches with a darkened expression. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Abel's faith teaches us something essential: true faith worships God on His terms, not ours. Abel brought the firstborn of his flock — the best he had — because he understood that approaching God requires giving our finest, not our leftovers. Cain brought an offering too, but his heart wasn't in it; he came on his own terms. The difference wasn't in the type of offering but in the posture of the heart behind it. By faith, Abel offered a "more excellent sacrifice" than Cain. And though Abel was murdered for his faithfulness, Scripture says he "still speaks" — his life echoes through eternity. Faith that truly worships costs us something. It asks: "Am I giving God my best, or am I giving Him whatever is convenient?"

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Imnet Abel agedasi neger yimhirena: Haqenya imnet ni'Amlak biNatu kunet imber biNatna aykonen zisgid. Abel bekuri nay megwas'e'u amts'i'e — iti ziblets'e zinebero — mikniyatu nab Amlak miqrab iti ziblets'e mihab kemziHatit teredi'u nebere. Qayen iwin meswi'eti amts'i'e, qinake libu ab'u ayneberen.

Scene 5 of 25

[PICTURE: Abraham standing at the edge of his homeland, looking out across vast unknown desert terrain with a caravan of camels and family behind him. Stars beginning to appear in the twilight sky. His expression shows courage mixed with uncertainty. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Abraham left everything familiar — his homeland, his father's house, his community — and went to a place he had never seen, knowing only that God had called him. He didn't have a map. He didn't have a five-year plan. He had only a promise: "I will make you into a great nation." Faith that steps into the unknown is perhaps the hardest kind. It means releasing control, admitting you don't know the next step, and trusting that the God who calls you will also guide you. Abraham lived in tents as a stranger in the land God promised him, because he was "looking forward to the city with foundations, whose architect and builder is God." He held the present loosely because he gripped the future tightly — not his own future, but God's.

Abraham kulu zifelTo gedifu — adu, bet abu'u, maHberu — nab fets'imu zeyri'ayo bota kede, Amlak kemziTs'ew'o tiray inafelete. Karta ayneberon. Nay hamush amet

Abraham kulu zifelTo gedifu — adu, bet abu'u, maHberu — nab fets'imu zeyri'ayo bota kede, Amlak kemziTs'ew'o tiray inafelete. Karta ayneberon. Nay hamush amet

*medeb ayneberon. Tesfa tiray nebero: "Abay hager kigibireKa iye." Nab zeytifileTo
zisgum imnet minalbat iti zikebede aynet iyu.*

Scene 6 of 25

[PICTURE: Sarah, elderly with white hair but radiant with joy, holding her newborn baby Isaac in her arms. Abraham stands beside her, tears of wonder on his weathered face. A starlit sky visible through the tent opening. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Sarah was ninety years old. Abraham was one hundred. Every biological reality said "impossible." Every medical fact said "too late." Yet by faith, Sarah received power to conceive and bear a child because she "considered Him faithful who had made the promise." This is faith that believes the impossible — not because the impossible becomes easy, but because the One who promised is trustworthy. Sarah laughed when she first heard the promise. God doesn't condemn our initial doubts; He works through them. But eventually Sarah moved from laughter of disbelief to laughter of joy as she held Isaac in her arms. When God promises something that seems impossible in your life, remember Sarah: the God who spoke the universe into existence is not limited by what seems possible to human eyes.

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Sara nay semanya amet idme nebera. Abraham mi'iti amet nebero. Kulu bayolojikawi Haqi "ayke'alin" bele. Kulu Hikminawi Haqi "diHiru iyu" bele. Yikun imber bi'imnet Sara nimTinas Hayli teqebelet mikniyatu "neti tesfa zihabe amina sle zirekebeTO." Izi

zeyke'al zi'amin imnet iyu — zeyke'al qelil sle ziKewn zeykone, iti tesfa zihabe amin sle ziKone.

Scene 7 of 25

[PICTURE: Abraham on Mount Moriah, knife raised but eyes lifted heavenward with tears streaming down his face. Young Isaac lies bound on the altar. A ram caught in a thicket is visible nearby. Divine light breaks through clouds. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Abraham offered Isaac — the son of promise, the child he had waited twenty-five years for, the boy who represented everything God had promised him. This is faith that surrenders our dearest treasures back to God. Abraham reasoned that God could even raise the dead, and in a manner of speaking, he did receive Isaac back from death. But consider the three-day journey to Mount Moriah — three days of walking with the knowledge of what God had asked. Three days of choosing obedience over agony. Faith doesn't mean the absence of pain; it means trusting God in the midst of pain so deep it threatens to break you. What is your "Isaac"? What is the thing you hold so tightly that giving it to God feels like death? Faith says: even this belongs to Him.

Abraham niYisHaq aqrebo — wedi tesfa, isran Hamuishten amet zitets'beyo qol'a, Amlak zitesfeo kulu zimelkit wedi. Izi ziKebere habtna nab Amlak ziHadig imnet iyu. Abraham Amlak nimwitat iwin kites'i'om kemziKh'il aselaselé, biHaqi dima niYisHaq kab mot teqebelo. Ginake nab keren Morya nay seleste me'alti gu'ezo Hiseb.

Abraham niYisHaq aqrebo — wedi tesfa, isran Hamuishten amet zitets'beyo qol'a, Amlak zitesfeo kulu zimelkit wedi. Izi ziKebere habtna nab Amlak ziHadig imnet iyu. Abraham Amlak nimwitat iwin kites'i'om kemziKh'il aselaselé, biHaqi dima niYisHaq kab mot teqebelo. Ginake nab keren Morya nay seleste me'alti gu'ezo Hiseb.

*wey tesfatat ayneberan — bi'imnet zitezareba nay Amlak ilama ab zimits'e weledo
zifnuw tinbitawi awajat nebera.*

*ni'us wedi Efrem anbere — mikniyatu imnet nay seb limdi zeykones nay Amlak li'ul
mirCHa yiKhtel.*

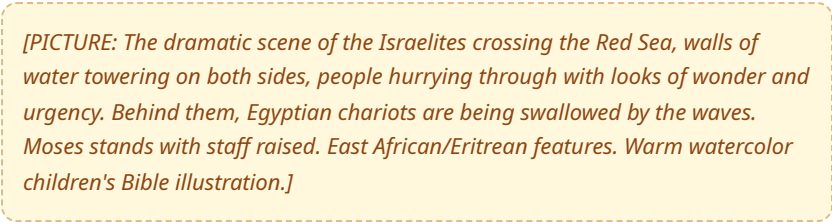
*ts'ilwa — ginake nay meweda'eta nay imnet gibru kab kulu nila'ili nab zi'abeye tesfa
Amlak miTimat nebere.*

*siwir mi'izaz ayHatitin. Nay seb Higi ni'ilama Amlak ab zits'ararielu gize imnet
ni'Amlak yimerTs.*

*Muse kab gیزیawi bahta HaTi'at miHguas mis hizbi Amlak miCHiquan kiqbel
merets'e. Ninay Kristos ts'erfi kab habti Gibitsi zi'abeye habti gebero, mikniyatu
ni'asbu yiTimt nebere. Izi waga ziQoTs'irin bifiQad ziKeflin imnet iyu. Muse kulu
nebero — bingisinit zitets'in'e, ab ziblets'e bet timhirti zitimhare, nisilTan zitmedebe.
Ginake kab kulu riHiqu kede.*

Ginake Muse keyferiHe kede. BiKemey? Mikniyatu zi'abeye seb rekHibu. Bi'akalawi aynu zeykone bi'ayni imnet neti zeyri'e Amlak te'azebe.

Scene 14 of 25



By faith, the people kept the Passover and the sprinkling of blood so that the destroyer would not touch their firstborn. By faith, they passed through the Red Sea as on dry land — but when the Egyptians tried to do so, they were drowned. This is faith that acts in crisis. When the angel of death was passing through Egypt, faith was not philosophical — it was urgent, practical, and specific: kill the lamb, apply the blood, stay inside. When the sea stood before them and Pharaoh's army behind them, faith was not passive — it walked forward into the impossible. Crisis reveals what we truly believe. When everything is comfortable, faith can be theoretical. But when death is at the door or the sea blocks your path, faith becomes action or it becomes nothing at all.

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Bi'imnet hizbi neti fasika minTs'ag dem akberu, iti aTifa'i nibekurom keytinkif.
Bi'imnet niqizra baHri kem binquTs midri Halefu — Gibitswyan kigibriwo mis fetenu

*gina TeHalu. Izi ab gize qiluwlaw zigber imnet iyu. Mel'akh mot ab Gibitsi ab
ziHalfeilu gize imnet filsifnawi ayneberen — hits'uts', tegbarawi, siru'e nebere.*

*amTsi'e, qiTs'ri teseqel. Amlak gina yibil: shidushte me'alti bihidi'at zur, diHri'u CHedir.
Imnet niseb'awi lojik zeyrid'u ab zikonelu gize iwin zeylimudat agebab Amlak yiKhtel.*

Scene 16 of 25

[PICTURE: Rahab at her window with a scarlet cord hanging down the wall, secretly sheltering two Israelite spies in her home. Her face shows courage and determination despite her fear. The city of Jericho looms behind her. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Rahab the prostitute — Scripture doesn't hide her past — welcomed the Israelite spies in peace and was not killed with those who were disobedient. Her faith came from the most unlikely place. She was a Canaanite, a pagan, a woman whose profession made her an outcast. Yet she heard about the God of Israel and believed. She risked everything — her life, her reputation, her place in society — to side with God's people. Rahab teaches us that faith has no prerequisites. You don't need a perfect past, a religious upbringing, or social respectability. You need only to hear about God's works and respond with trust. Rahab became an ancestor of King David and of Jesus Christ Himself. Faith transforms anyone — regardless of where they've been — into someone with an extraordinary future.

[illegible]

*Rahab ita amenizra — qidus ts'Huf niHilufa ayHab'on — niseleyti Isra'el bisalam
teqebeleTom mis'itom zeyi'izuzat dima ayTefe'atin. Imneta kab ziKhef'e bota mets'e.
Kene'anawit neberet, aremawit, sirHa ziTelemela sebeiyti. Ginake biza'iba Amlak*

*Isra'el semi'a amenet. Kulu neger Hadega wesedet — hiweta, shima, ab Hibreteseb
zielwa bota — mis hizbi Amlak kitwegen.*

*Yoftahe hilukh mebtSi'a atewe. Ginake kulom ab diKamomn gudletomn nay zeyilmud
imnet himot rekHebu.*

Scene 18 of 25

[PICTURE: David as a young shepherd with his sling facing unseen giants, Samuel anointing a king with oil, and prophets like Elijah standing boldly before hostile crowds. A timeline of faithfulness stretching across generations. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

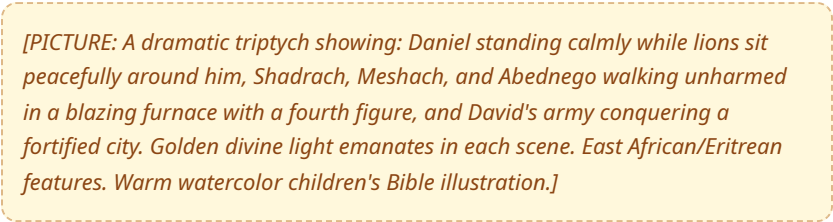
David — a shepherd boy who became a king, who sinned grievously yet was called "a man after God's own heart" because he always returned to faith through repentance. Samuel — dedicated to God before birth, faithful in service from childhood, speaking truth to power throughout his life. The prophets — Isaiah, Jeremiah, Elijah, Elisha — who stood alone against entire nations, who spoke God's uncomfortable truth when everyone wanted comfortable lies. Faith that endures is not faith that never falters. It is faith that, after falling, gets back up. After doubting, chooses again. After failing, returns to God. The Hall of Faith is not a collection of unbroken winning streaks — it is a testimony of people who kept coming back to God no matter how many times they stumbled on the way.

[illegible]

*Dawit — nigus ziKone gwas'a qol'a, biKebid ziHaT'e ginake binsiHa kulu gize nab
imnet sle zitemelise "libi Amlak zideleyo seb" zitebahle. Samuel — qidmi miwladu
ni'Amlak zitewefeye, kab qull'inetu ab agelqilot amin nebere, ab kulu hiywetu nisiTan*

*Haqi tezaribu. Nebiyat — Isayyas, Ermyas, Elyas, Elisha — nimilu'e hageratat
beiynom ziqomu.*

Scene 19 of 25



Who through faith conquered kingdoms, administered justice, and gained what was promised. Who shut the mouths of lions — think of Daniel, spending a night surrounded by predators, yet sleeping peacefully because God was his shield. Who quenched the fury of the flames — think of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, who said to the most powerful king on earth: "Our God is able to deliver us. But even if He does not, we will not bow." That phrase — "even if He does not" — is the highest expression of faith. It says: I trust God whether He rescues me or not. My obedience is not conditioned on the outcome. These heroes didn't know the ending when they stepped into the lions' den or the furnace. They acted in faith before they saw deliverance — and that is exactly what faith requires of us.

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Bi'imnet mengistitat zise'aru, fitiHi zimaHderu, tesfa zirekHebu. Af anabis zi'ats'ewu
— niDani'el Hiseb, bi'adalat tekHbibu gina Amlak walta'u sle ziKone bisalam
ziHadere. Hayli Hawi ziTef'u — niShadrak, Meshak, Abednigo Hiseb, neti ab midri

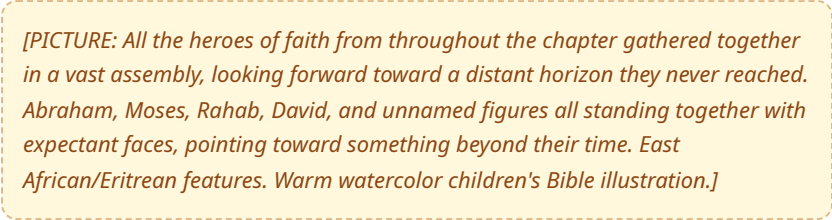
*ziHayele nigus "AmlakHna kediHnena yiKh'il iyu. Ginake intezeyedHanena iwin
aynisgdin" zibelu.*

*Gele aminti te'amirawi diHnet re'ayu — miwtat tensí'om, Himumat Hawiyom, zeyke'al
tefets'eme. Ginake kal'ot — bima'ire aminti, bima'ire aminom — tesaqeyun teqetlun.*

*abag'ie qorbetin zewteru, ziteHaremu, zitesaqeyu, ziteCheqenu. Izi zeyHadig imnet
iyu — ziri'e asbi ab zeybilu gize, miHret ab zeybilu gize zits'en'e imnet.*

"Alem bi'atatom aytegebi'atin." Zedenits'uw firdi! Izi'om ab berekatattin akranin zizeweru, ab be'atitatín gudagwid midrin zinebru — alem ri'iyatom feshelti, tesa'irom, tebareri belet. Ginake semay ri'iyatom, iza alem nezi'om sebat ayigbi'atin bele. Nay alem firdin nay semay firdin milu'e bimilu'e teqelbisom iyom.

Scene 23 of 25



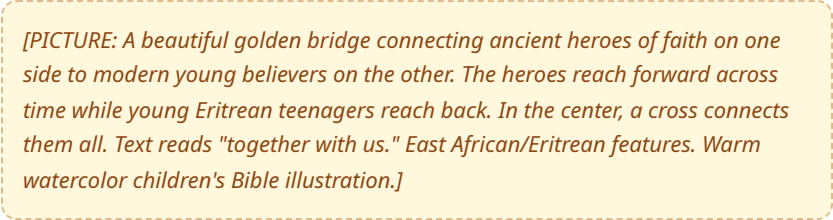
These were ALL commended for their faith, yet NONE of them received what had been promised. Let that sink in. Abraham never saw the great nation. Moses never entered the Promised Land. David never saw the eternal kingdom. The prophets never saw their words fulfilled in their lifetime. Every single person in this Hall of Faith died without receiving the full promise. They saw it from a distance, welcomed it, and admitted they were strangers and pilgrims on earth. This is perhaps the hardest truth about faith: it may not be rewarded in your lifetime. You may plant seeds you never see bloom. You may fight battles whose victories come after you. You may believe promises whose fulfillment belongs to the next generation. And THAT is still called faith. Real faith doesn't demand immediate returns.

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ስጋፍፍፍ ስጋ ስጋፍ ስጋፍ ስጋፍ ስጋፍፍፍፍ ስጋ ስጋ ስጋፍ ስጋፍ ስጋፍፍፍፍ ስጋፍ
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*Kulom bi'imnetom temesegenu, ginake hade ikwa zitetesfeo ayteqebelen. HisebewO.
Abraham neta abay hager fets'imu ayri'ayan. Muse nab midri tesfa ayi'atewen. Dawit*

*neta nay zele'alem mengisti ayri'ayan. Nebiyat qalom ab hiywetiom tefets'imu
ayri'ayun. Ab adarash imnet zelo kulu seb milu'e tesfa keytiqebele mote.*

Scene 24 of 25



God had planned something better for us — that only together with us would they be made perfect. This is the breathtaking conclusion: we are not merely reading about these heroes from the outside. We are part of their story. God's plan was never for them alone — it was always for all of us, across all generations, together. Their faith and our faith are threads in the same tapestry. They needed us to complete the picture, and we need them to understand where we fit. The promise they waited for includes you. The story they started, you are continuing. The faith they demonstrated, you are called to carry forward. You are not reading a closed history book — you are writing the next chapter. The Hall of Faith has empty frames on the wall, waiting for your portrait to be hung alongside Abraham, Moses, and Rahab.

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Amlak ni'ana ziHashe neger aqedimu Hasibu nebere — bizey ni'ana fits'umat keyKonu. Izi zedenits'uw medemdemta iyu: nezi'om jeganu kab wets'a'i tiray

*aynenibibomon alena — nay tariKhom kifal ina. Nay Amlak medeb ni'a'om beinyom
fets'imu ayneberen — kulu gize nikulna, ab kulu weledo, biHabar nebere.*

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፳፻፱ ፳፻፱፱፱ ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱፱ ፳፻፱፱ — ፳፻፱ ፳፻፱፱ ፳፻፱፱ ፳፻፱

*Slezi kemzi bizi'amsele bizuH debena miskrat tekHbibna sle zelena, nikulu ziKhbidna
negerIn qelTifu zi'asrena HaTi'atin ariHiqna derbina, ab qidmena zelo qididim
bits'in'at nigoye, nab Yesus nab'ti nay imnet felamín fets'amín niTimt. BeiyiniKha
ayKonkan tigoiy zeleKha. Kulu abzi mi'iraf zelo jigna kab kof mebeji yitebabi'aKa alo.*

The Moral of the Story

Faith is not passive belief — it is active trust in God despite not seeing the outcome. The heroes of Hebrews 11 did not have all the answers. They faced doubt, ridicule, suffering, and death. Yet they chose to trust God's character over their circumstances, God's promises over their fears, and God's timeline over their impatience.

We are part of the same story as these heroes. Their faith and ours are woven together into one great tapestry of God's purposes across all generations. They needed us to complete the picture, and we need them to remind us that faith has always been costly, always been uncertain from a human perspective, and always been worth it.

You are not called to a faith that has all the answers — you are called to a faith that trusts the One who does. Run your race. Throw off what hinders you. Fix your eyes on Jesus. And know that a great cloud of witnesses is cheering you on.

Key Verse: "Now faith is confidence in what we hope for and assurance about what we do not see." — Hebrews 11:1

[illegible]

Discussion Questions

1. What is the difference between faith and blind belief? How does Hebrews 11:1 define faith as something substantive — "evidence" and "substance" — rather than mere wishful thinking? When people say faith is believing without evidence, how would you respond using this chapter?

1. ስለ ፍጥነት ምንምምን ምን ምን ምንምም ምን ምንም ምንም ምን? ምንምም 11:1 ምንምም ምን "ምንምም" "ምንምም" ምን ምን ምን ምን ምንም ምንም? ምን ምንም ምን ምንምም ምንም ምን ምን ምን ምንም ምንም ምንም ምንም?

2. Moses counted the cost of faith — leaving Egypt's pleasures for suffering with God's people. What does "counting the cost" look like for a young person today? What are the "treasures of Egypt" in your world — the things that tempt you away from faithfulness?

2. ምን ምን ምንም ምን ምን — ምንም ምን ምን ምንም ምን ምን ምንም ምንም "ምን ምንም" ምን ምንምም ምንም ምንም? ምን ምንም "ምንም ምንም" — ምን ምንም ምንምም ምንም — ምንም ምን?

3. Many of these heroes — Gideon, Moses, Sarah — struggled with doubt before acting in faith. Does doubt disqualify you from faith? How do these examples show that faith and doubt can coexist, and that God works through imperfect, questioning people?

3. ምንም ምንምም ምንም — ምንምም ምንም ምን — ምንምም ምን ምንም ምንምም ምንምም ምንም ምን ምንም ምንምም ምን? ምንም ምንምም ምንምም ምንምም ምንም ምንም ምን ምንምም ምንም ምን ምንምምም ምንምም ምን ምን ምንም ምንም ምንም?

4. "○○○○ ○○○ ○○○○ ○○○○" ○○○ ○○○○ ○○○ ○○? ○○○○ ○○○○○○ ○○○
 ○○○ ○○ ○○○○ ○○○ ○○○○ ○○○○ ○○○○ ○○○○ ○○○○ ○○○○? ○○○○○○
 ○○○ ○○○ ○○○ ○○○ ○○○○?

[illegible]

A Prayer of Faith

Almighty God, Author and Perfecter of our faith, we come before You humbled by the testimony of those who have gone before us. We ask for the faith of Abel — faith that worships You on Your terms. We ask for the faith of Enoch — faith that walks with You daily. We ask for the faith of Noah — faith that obeys despite ridicule. We ask for the faith of Abraham — faith that steps into the unknown trusting Your voice.

Give us the faith of Moses — faith that counts the cost and chooses You over comfort. Give us the faith of Rahab — faith that dares to believe regardless of our past. Give us the faith of those unnamed heroes who endured suffering without quitting, who wandered in caves yet refused to abandon You.

Lord, we confess our doubts, our fears, our tendency to choose the easy path. Forgive us for the times we have demanded proof before obedience, comfort before commitment, and guarantees before trust. Teach us that faith is not the absence of questions but the presence of trust despite them.

Help us to run our race with endurance — not someone else's race, but the one You have marked out for us. Help us throw off every weight that slows us down and every sin that entangles us. Fix our eyes on Jesus, who endured the cross for the joy set before Him.

And remind us daily that we are not alone — that a great cloud of witnesses surrounds us, cheering us forward, testifying that You are faithful. May we be found worthy to join their number. In the name of Jesus, the Pioneer and Perfecter of our faith. Amen.

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Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Contact: dannyshalom.etsy.com

Email: Dannyshalomnebiy@gmail.com

WhatsApp: +971525950021

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